

theatre festival

Role Reversal

BANGALORE Kings, queens, colourful landscapes painted on gigantic backdrops, warring lords and stylised drama—it is with nostalgia that one remembers the tradition of the travelling company theatres which enthralled Indians for several decades. With very few companies still remaining in the country, and most languishing for want of resources, Ranga Shankara zoomed in on the tradition of the Company Style of Drama as the theme for this year's annual festival. It will provide an insight into the style that influenced modern Indian theatre. There is *Nati Binodini* directed by Amal Allana and based on the immortal stage actor. Other plays include Satish Alekar's *Begum Barve*, based in the period when male actors essayed female roles in theatre and Bharat Natya Sam-shodhan Mandir's production *Kati-aar Kaajjaat Ghusli*. One of

the highlights of the festival is a production of *Maya Bazaar* by Surabhi theatre from Andhra Pradesh.

The 120-year-old company is one of the few remaining Company-style theatres in the country. *Sadarame*, a Kannada play, performed by Gubbi Veeranna more than five decades ago will be revived by his grand daughter, veteran actor and director B. Jayashree. She will play the role that her grandfather had in the original enactment, thus completing the circle of gender reversal in theatre.

The festival will also comprise film screenings, music concerts and discussions on the role of music in the sangeet-natak tradition in theatre, besides solo performances by thespians from company theatres across the country. There will also be an art and theatre appreciation course for students and art enthusiasts along with an exhibition of rare archival photographs. To be held from October 31 to November 9 at Ranga Shankara.

by Nirmala Ravindran

ALL WORK AND PLAY: Actors performing *Maya Bazaar*



festival

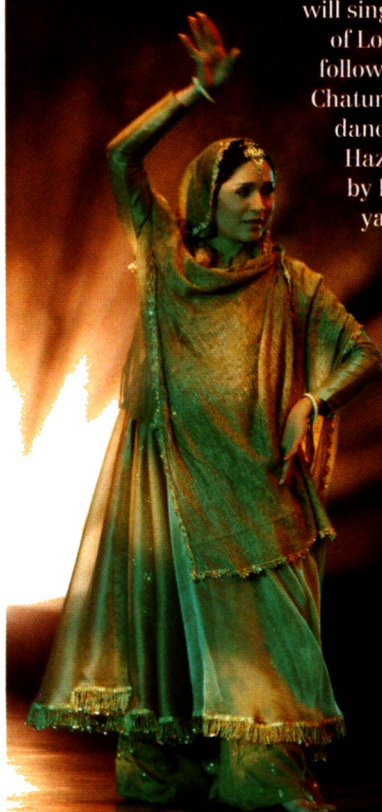
Divine Acts

JAIPUR An artiste's most memorable experience is the moment he is inspired to sing or perform to a phrase from a religious text and feels elevated to a superior plane. Experience these spiritual moments in a two-day festival, Bhakti Rang, conceptualised by Sufi Kathak dancer, Manjari Chaturvedi. On the first day,

Pandits Rajan and Sajan Mishra will sing their interpretation of Lord Krishna's life. It is followed by Sufi Kathak by Chaturvedi where she will dance to the poetry of Hazrat Amir Khusro sung by Rajasthan Manganiyars. On the second day,

Prahlad Singh Tipaniya from Madhya Pradesh will sing compositions on Ram as described by Kabir, while the qawwals, Zaki and Zakir Ali of Ajmer Sharif, will sing scintillating qawallis. Ustad Shafqat Ali Khan will sing Punjabi Sufiana Kalam. At the Open Air Theatre. On November 1 and 2.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

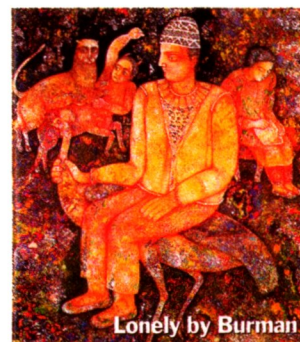


Chaturvedi

art exhibition

Narrating Strokes

DELHI Sakti Burman is back after three years with a solo show. The exhibition, more than 20 oils and watercolours, has a distinct style of continuous narration by recurring motifs of the 1960s. He is fascinated with the Italian frescoes and the cave murals in Ajanta, which is reflected in his watercolours. His paintings take the viewer on a journey where ideas



Lonely by Burman

and objects from the ancient mythologies and histories of civilisations merge in a personal narration. At the Art Alive Gallery, from October 25 to November 6.